of the statement which are not redacted, there is a reference to the ‘starving and struggling millions’ of their countrymen who ‘were deprived of their primary right and the sole means of improving their economic welfare’ so that ‘none who has felt like us for the dumb-driven drudges of labourers could possibly witness this spectacle with equanimity’ and ‘none whose heart bleeds for those who have given their life-blood in silence to the building up of the economic structure of the Exploiters, of whom the Government happens to be the biggest in this country, could repress the cry of soul-agonising anguish which so ruthless a blow wrung out of our hearts’.[8]

Third, it is against this background that Bhagat Singh and B.K. Dutt reject the notion of Gandhian ‘utopian non-violence’ in preference to the use of legitimate revolutionary force against the oppressor and the idea of revolution. Unfortunately, this was redacted from the statement presented before the sessions court, but what they wished to do here was to draw attention to ‘the end of utopian non-violence of whose futility the rising generation has been convinced beyond the shadow of doubt’. What the sessions court did get to learn of, however, was their justification for the use of force, in a way which showed them to have been far more sophisticated than Mahatma Gandhi’s passive non-cooperation, in that, ‘Force when aggressively applied is “violence” and is therefore morally unjustifiable; but when it is used in the furtherance of a legitimate cause it has its moral justification,’ a suggestion that Frantz Fanon forty years later would not have resiled from. The authorities apparently then, however, considered what was to follow from these words to be objectionable, because the following context of the use of force is expunged, and yet it is deeply revealing:

> The elimination of force at all costs is utopian and the new movement which has arisen in the country, and of which we have given the warning, is inspired by the ideals which guided Guru Gobind Singh and Shivaji, Kamal Pasha & Riza Khan, Washington & Garibaldi, Lafayette & Lenin.[9]